



Origins of ROS

Learning how one of the most popular platforms - Robot Operating System - came to be

Robot Operating Systems or 'ROS' began as a personal effort of Keenan Wyrobek and Eric Berger while at Stanford, as an attempt to avoid the robotics industry's reinventing-the-wheel scenario. These two guys were concerned about the most common problem in robotics at the time: too much time spent re-implementing the software infrastructure required to build complex robotics algorithms (basically, drivers for sensors and actuators, as well as communications between different programmes within the same robot), and too little time spent actually building intelligent robotics programmes based on that infrastructure.

Even within the same organisation, each new project required the re-invention of the drivers and communication systems. Keenan and Eric beautifully illustrated this predicament in one of their investor pitch slides.